

Document 13: Alumni Network & Mentorship Guidelines

Institution: Hyderabad Institute of Technology (HIT)

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1. The HIT Alumni Association (HITAA) Membership Protocols

The Hyderabad Institute of Technology Alumni Association (HITAA) is the official, legally registered nodal agency responsible for maintaining lifelong relationships between the institution and its graduates. The university views its alumni as its greatest strategic asset, serving as brand ambassadors in the global corporate ecosystem and providing critical infrastructural support to subsequent generations of engineering students.

Membership into the HITAA is not optional for graduating cohorts; it is a mandatory administrative procedure integrated directly into the graduation clearance workflow. A one-time Lifetime Alumni Membership Fee of ₹2,500 is automatically deducted from the student's refundable hostel or library security deposit during their eighth-semester clearance process. Upon payment, the graduate is issued a biometric "Silver Tier" Alumni Identity Card and granted permanent digital access to the global HITAA web portal.

Alumni who subsequently achieve highly distinguished positions—defined strictly as C-level executive roles in publicly traded companies, civil service ranks of Joint Secretary or higher, or founders of venture-backed startups with valuations exceeding fifty million dollars—are elevated by the institutional Senate to the "Gold Tier." Gold Tier alumni receive premium campus privileges, including VIP parking access, lifetime invitations to the annual convocation stage, and unrestricted booking rights for the executive university guest house.

2. The "AlumBridge" Strategic Mentorship Framework

To leverage the vast industrial experience of its graduates, the university operates the "AlumBridge" mentorship program. This highly regulated initiative pairs current undergraduate students with established alumni for a period of six months to provide intense, one-on-one career coaching, technical guidance, and networking opportunities.

Participation in the AlumBridge program is heavily gatekept. It is open exclusively to students currently enrolled in their fifth or sixth semesters (third year). Freshmen and sophomores are deemed too early in their academic journey to benefit from targeted corporate mentoring, while final-year students are expected to be fully engaged with the Training and Placement Cell. To apply, an eligible third-year student must maintain a minimum CGPA of 7.5, possess zero active backlogs, and submit a one-thousand-word Statement of Purpose (SOP) outlining their specific career trajectory.

The matching algorithm is strictly controlled by the Alumni Affairs Office. Students are not permitted to personally solicit mentorship from high-profile alumni via LinkedIn or private emails. All pairing is done internally based on domain alignment. For example, a student whose SOP focuses on artificial intelligence in healthcare will be exclusively paired with an alumnus working in biomedical machine learning. Once a match is formalized, the mentor and mentee are legally bound to conduct a minimum of two hours of virtual interaction per month, which must be logged and digitally countersigned on the AlumBridge portal.

3. Regulations on Alumni Financial Endowments and Scholarships

Many successful graduates express a desire to give back to their alma mater through financial contributions. However, to prevent money laundering, favoritism, and tax fraud, the university strictly dictates the financial pipelines through which alumni capital can enter the campus ecosystem.

Alumni are absolutely prohibited from transferring cash, executing direct bank transfers, or handing physical checks directly to any individual student, student club, or faculty member. All financial contributions must be routed exclusively through the centralized, government-audited "HIT Institutional Endowment Foundation."

If an alumnus wishes to establish a "Named Scholarship" (e.g., *The Rajesh Sharma Memorial Scholarship for Women in Tech*), they must deposit a minimum unspendable corpus fund of ₹10,00,000 (Ten Lakh Rupees). The university will lock this corpus in a high-yield government fixed deposit and utilize strictly the annual interest generated to fund the tuition of the selected student. The criteria for selecting the scholarship recipient can be suggested by the alumnus (e.g., "highest scoring female student in Mechanical Engineering"), but the final selection and interview process is conducted solely by the institutional financial aid committee to ensure absolute transparency.

4. Alumni Guest Lectures and Campus Access Privileges

The university actively encourages alumni to return to the campus to deliver technical masterclasses, conduct mock interviews, or share industry trends. However, their physical presence on campus is governed by distinct security and logistical protocols to prevent disruption of standard academic activities.

An alumnus holding a standard Silver Tier ID card cannot simply walk into a lecture hall and begin teaching. If a student club or a departmental head wishes to invite an alumnus for a guest lecture, they must submit a formal "Speaker Clearance Request" to the Dean of Alumni Affairs at least fourteen calendar days in advance. The alumnus must submit the slide deck or presentation materials for a rapid preliminary review to ensure the content is purely educational and does not contain unauthorized corporate recruitment pitches or political propaganda.

Regarding financial compensation, the university operates on a strict pro-bono philosophy for alumni speakers. No honorarium or speaking fee is paid to an alumnus under any circumstances, as giving back to the institution is considered an ethical duty. However, the university will reimburse domestic travel logistics. If an invited alumnus is flying in from another Indian city, the university will reimburse economy-class airfare capped at a maximum of ₹15,000, alongside providing complimentary accommodation and dining in the campus executive guest house for a maximum of two nights. International travel expenses are strictly non-reimbursable.

5. Global Chapter Formation and Institutional Funding

As HIT graduates disperse across the globe, the university supports the establishment of localized international and domestic alumni chapters (e.g., HITAA Silicon Valley Chapter, HITAA London Chapter, HITAA Bangalore Chapter) to foster regional networking and corporate referrals.

To officially register a new regional chapter, the organizing committee must demonstrate a concentrated demographic presence by collecting the digital signatures of at least fifty verified alumni currently residing within a one-hundred-kilometer radius of the proposed chapter headquarters.

Once recognized by the institutional Senate, the regional chapter becomes eligible for an annual institutional grant of ₹1,00,000 (One Lakh Rupees). This funding is strictly earmarked for renting conference venues for the annual chapter meet, hosting networking dinners, or printing official HIT merchandise. The chapter president must submit a rigorously audited expense report with original GST invoices by the end of the financial year. Failure to submit this audit results in the immediate freezing of the chapter's charter and the permanent cessation of all future university funding.

6. Code of Conduct Revocation and Disciplinary Excommunication

Graduation does not grant an alumnus permanent immunity from institutional oversight. The university fiercely protects its brand reputation and the safety of its current student body. As such, the Alumni Affairs Office holds the unilateral authority to permanently revoke an individual's alumni status and excommunicate them from the institutional network.

Interaction between alumni and current students must remain strictly professional. If an alumnus utilizes the AlumBridge mentorship portal to harass a student, make inappropriate romantic advances, or demand unpaid labor for their personal startup, the student is instructed to trigger the "Red Flag" button on the portal. This results in the immediate suspension of the alumnus's portal access and a formal investigation by the institutional grievance committee.

Furthermore, if an alumnus is convicted of a severe felony in a court of law, found guilty of massive corporate financial fraud (such as insider trading or embezzlement), or caught maliciously defaming the university in the public press, the institution will execute a "Status Revocation." The individual's Alumni ID card is digitally deactivated, their name is permanently scrubbed from the digital Hall of Fame, they are banned from entering the campus premises, and the Training and Placement Cell will actively issue advisories warning current students against seeking employment at the excommunicated individual's companies.